



WHITE PAPER • ENTERPRISE EDITION FOR BFSI • INDIA

Audit-Ready Multi-Cloud for Indian Banking

How Indian banks, NBFCs and financial institutions run multi-cloud estates that satisfy the RBI, CERT-In, the DPDP Act and their own boards — with evidence by default, exit plans that are rehearsable, and cloud economics the CFO signs. BlueWhale Stack Enterprise Edition, fitted to the most regulated industry in India.

Executive Summary

No industry in India carries a heavier compliance load into the cloud than banking. The workloads are the most sensitive, the regulator is the most engaged, and the consequences of a finding are the most public. Yet the pressure to modernize — UPI-scale payments, digital lending, analytics, AI — is equally relentless. The result is the defining tension of Indian bank IT: **move fast enough for the business, provably enough for the RBI.**

This paper describes how the BlueWhale Stack Enterprise Edition resolves that tension: one control plane across the bank's public cloud, private cloud and on-premises estates, with uniform policy, continuous compliance monitoring, examiner-grade evidence, Whalenomics cost governance, and a Migration Engine that turns the RBI's exit-strategy requirement from a document into a rehearsable capability.

One

control plane across every environment the bank runs — evidence generated, not assembled

6 regimes

RBI • CERT-In • DPDP • SEBI mapped to platform capability, page 4

In-India

BYOC and sovereign deployment — the control plane inside the jurisdiction

Exit-ready

the outsourcing exit plan as a rehearsable migration programme

Who should read this

CIOs, CTOs, CISOs and Heads of Infrastructure at scheduled commercial banks, small finance banks, NBFCs, insurers and payment companies; Chief Compliance Officers and internal audit heads who own the inspection; and CFOs accountable for a cloud line that grows every quarter.

The claim this paper defends: for an Indian bank, compliance is not a constraint on cloud strategy — done architecturally, it is the cloud strategy. A control proven once and evidenced everywhere beats a faster estate that fails its next inspection.

The Problem, as the Inspector Sees It

1. Controls differ per environment

The bank's estate spans a hyperscaler or two, a private cloud beside the core banking system, and on-premises infrastructure that will outlive every roadmap. Each enforces policy differently — so a control the bank genuinely operates still surfaces as an inconsistency finding, because it cannot be evidenced identically everywhere.

2. Evidence is assembled, not generated

RBI inspections, concurrent audits, CERT-In obligations and internal audit all draw on the same facts — but each request triggers weeks of manual assembly across consoles, spreadsheets and screenshots. The audit calendar, not the technology, sets the pace of change.

3. The exit plan is a document, not a capability

The RBI's 2023 outsourcing directions require a documented, executable exit strategy from every material service provider. In most banks that strategy has never been tested — because without dependency mapping and rehearsed migration, testing it would be the riskiest project of the year.

4. Cost without an owner

Cloud spend spreads across business units, projects and environments with no chargeback discipline — and the CFO signs a number nobody can decompose.

5. AI ambition meets data caution

Every bank wants AI in operations and compliance; no bank wants customer data reaching a public AI service. Most tooling forces the choice.

The pattern: none of these are technology gaps — the bank owns firewalls, scanners and cost tools. They are *architecture* gaps: capabilities that exist per-environment but not across the estate, which is precisely where the regulator looks.

✓ Six Regimes, One Control Plane

The table below maps the regulatory landscape an Indian bank actually answers to against the Enterprise Edition capability that carries each obligation. This is the page to hand the compliance officer.

Regulation / direction	What it demands	How the Enterprise Edition carries it
RBI IT Outsourcing Directions, 2023	Documented exit strategy, vendor concentration limits, right-to-audit, service continuity	Migration Engine gives the exit plan teeth — assessed, mapped, rehearsable; multi-cloud placement addresses concentration; Cloud Audit produces the inspection trail
RBI Cyber Security Framework (2016) & IT Governance Directions (2023)	SOC capability, continuous surveillance, board-level IT governance, log retention	Continuous security scanning, Observability and activity logging; audit-ready reporting the board and the inspector read from the same source
RBI Payment Data Localisation (2018)	End-to-end payment data stored only in India	BYOC and sovereign deployment keep workloads, logs, identity and the control plane itself in-country
CERT-In Directions (2022)	6-hour incident reporting; 180-day log retention; time synchronisation	Centralized activity logging with retention policy; alerting feeds the 6-hour clock instead of consuming it
DPDP Act, 2023	Personal-data governance, purpose limitation, breach obligations	Data-residency control, RBAC with enterprise identity, privacy enforcement and evidence export
SEBI CSCRF (2024) — broking & MF arms	Cyber resilience framework across market intermediaries	The same uniform control plane covers the group's capital-markets entities — one framework, evidenced once

The platform provides alignment capability and evidence; it does not constitute legal or regulatory certification. Obligations summarized; banks should map their specific applicability with compliance counsel.

The structural point: these six regimes overlap heavily — logging, access control, residency, resilience, auditability. Answered per-regulation, the bank does the work six times. Answered at the platform layer, one control plane carries all six — and the next circular lands on architecture that already generates evidence.

Architecture — the Bank's Estate, **One Plane**

The bank's workloads

Digital channels & UPI-scale payments · lending & origination · analytics & risk · regulatory reporting · CBS-adjacent systems · group entities (broking, insurance, AMC)

SHARED CORE MODULES (GOLD = DECISIVE FOR THE BANK)

Unified Cloud Mgmt	Identity & Access	Tenant & Partner Program	ITSM Integration
Discovery & Assessment	Service Catalog	Whalenomics · FinOps	Cloud Audit

ENTERPRISE EDITION MODULES — ALL INCLUDED

Whale AI — incl. offline	Migration Engine	Observability	Security — advanced scanning
Advanced ITSM	Landing Zone Builder	Edge Agent	Extended Connectors

The estate it governs

Public cloud regions in India · private cloud beside the core · on-premises datacenters · DR sites — one policy, one evidence stream, everywhere.

RUNS ACROSS

									
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Deployment for a regulated bank

BYOC

The control plane in the bank's own cloud tenancy — India regions, bank-controlled keys and identity.

Sovereign / on-premises

Deployed in the bank's datacenter where policy requires — nothing leaves the perimeter, including the AI.

SaaS (non-core)

Fastest path for non-material workloads, with an in-place route to BYOC as scope grows.

Reading the diagram: the decisive fact for a bank is that audit, identity, cost and residency live in the *shared* layer — a control proven once is evidenced identically in every environment, which is the exact opposite of how findings happen.

Four Banking Scenarios

RBI inspection, prepared in days

Uniform controls enforced platform-wide; continuous compliance monitoring; inspection evidence generated as reports rather than assembled as screenshots. The audit binder becomes a report parameter — and the concurrent auditor reads from the same source as the board pack.

The exit plan, rehearsed

Discovery and dependency mapping across the estate; migration waves planned and rehearsed against a second provider or the bank's own datacenter; the RBI outsourcing exit strategy converted from an annexure into an annual drill — with evidence of the drill.

UPI-scale economics, decomposed

Whalenomics gives every business unit its own budget, forecast and chargeback; payment-peak capacity is planned with a price tag; idle and oversized resources surface continuously. The CFO signs a number the platform can decompose to the workload.

AI inside the perimeter

Whale AI's offline models bring AI-assisted operations, documentation and compliance reporting to estates whose data cannot reach public AI services — the bank gets the leverage without the data-sharing conversation.

Field heritage: the platform productizes eight years of consulting across banking and financial services in India and the GCC — including global payments and regulated-enterprise engagements. The workflows are transcribed from this industry, not imagined for it.



Getting Started

Step	What happens	Duration
1 • Discovery workshop	Map the estate, the regulatory calendar and the audit pain points; agree prototype scope with compliance in the room.	One week
2 • 90-day prototype	The Enterprise Edition live on the bank's real environments — discovery, policy, audit reporting and Whalenomics on actual workloads; full-featured, no licence cost.	2–4 weeks to first insight
3 • The inspection test	Day-90 review scored the way the bank is scored: could this evidence stand in front of the inspector? Findings, scorecard, deployment recommendation.	Day-90 review

About BlueWhale Stack

Founded in 2018 as a cloud consulting firm; the BlueWhale Stack platform launched in 2026 — eight years of regulated-industry field experience, productized — delivered alongside consulting practices in Application, Data & AI and Infrastructure Modernization.

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Next step: request the discovery workshop through your BlueWhale Stack representative or authorized partner — and bring the last inspection's findings list. The prototype is scoped against it.

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